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Hironori Kato, Dr. Eng.
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Degree: Doctor of Engineering (The University of Tokyo, 1999)
Expertise: transportation planning and policy, transportation economics, transportation finance, and travel behavioral analysis

Dr. Hironori Kato is an academic and expert in transportation planning and policy, currently serving as a Full Professor in the Department of Civil Engineering at the Graduate School of Engineering, The University of Tokyo. Since joining the university as a faculty member about 25 years ago, he has built a reputation as a leading figure in transportation policy, infrastructure planning, and international engineering education.

Dr. Kato completed his undergraduate, master, and doctoral studies at The University of Tokyo, earning his doctoral degree in Civil Engineering in 1999. After beginning his career as a Research Associate at the same institution, he went on to serve as a Project Manager at the Institute of Transport Policy Studies in Tokyo. In 2013, Dr. Kato was appointed Full Professor at The University of Tokyo. Since then, he has taken on multiple academic leadership roles, including his current position as Director of the Division of Engineering Education at the Institute for Innovation in International Engineering Education. Since 2016, he has also served as Co-Director of the Master in Civil Engineering (MCE) Program at Vietnam Japan University (VJU) in Hanoi. In 2023, he was also appointed to the Board of Directors of the Japan Transport and Tourism Research Institute (JTTRI).

Dr. Kato is widely recognized for his scholarly contributions in the fields of transportation planning and policy and infrastructure management. His work has been published in some of the most prestigious journals in the field, including Transportation Research (Parts A, B, and F), Transport Policy, Transport Reviews, Transportation, Journal of Transport Geography, Sustainable Cities and Society, and Transportation Research Record. He has authored or co-authored: over 120 peer-reviewed journal articles, including more than 90 in JCR-indexed journals; more than 160 conference presentations at major international venues; over 10 book chapters, and more than 230 invited lectures and keynote presentations across global academic and policy forums

He has long been committed to bridging the gap between academic research and public policy. He has contributed to more than 200 governmental advisory and research committees at both the national and local levels in Japan. His roles have included serving as a Special Member of the Council for Transport Policy under the Ministry of Land, Infrastructure, Transport and Tourism, where he has advised on strategic planning for airports, seaports, and rail systems. His international advisory work includes technical support for infrastructure and urban development projects under the Japan International Cooperation Agency, as well as participation in global initiatives led by the Asian Development Bank (ADB) and the International Transport Forum under the OECD.

Dr. Kato is actively involved in shaping the direction of transportation research and education in Asia and beyond. He is a long-standing member of leading academic societies such as the Eastern Asia Society for Transportation Studies (EASTS) and the Asian Civil Engineering Coordinating Council (ACECC), and regularly contributes to the Japan Society of Civil Engineers. He has also served extensively in editorial roles, helping to elevate the quality and reach of academic publications in his field. These roles include: Editor-in-Chief of Asian Transport Studies (for nearly a decade); Editorial Advisory Board Member of Transportation; Academic Editor for PLOS One; Associate Editor of Urban Rail Transit; and Reviewer Board Member of Sustainability. As a peer reviewer, he has evaluated more than 370 manuscripts across over 70 international journals and conferences.

Over the course of his career, Dr. Kato has served as Principal Investigator on numerous competitively funded research projects. To date, he has secured over 320 million JPY (approximately 2.2 million USD, as of September 2025) in research funding from agencies such as: Japan Society for the Promotion of Science; Japan Science and Technology Agency; Ministry of Land, Infrastructure, Transport and Tourism; and Asian Development Bank.

Dr. Kato's academic excellence and teaching achievements have been widely recognized. His honors include: Best Paper Awards, Eastern Asia Society for Transportation Studies (2019, 2015); Kometani-Sasaki Award, Kometani-Sasaki Foundation (2014); JSTE Award, Japan Society of Transportation Economics (2014); Outstanding Paper Award, Emerald Literati Network Awards (2014); Best Teaching Award of the Year, Faculty of Engineering, The University of Tokyo (2015).

For more information about Dr. Kato’s work, including a full list of publications, current projects, and collaboration opportunities, please visit his personal website: http://www.trip.t.u-tokyo.ac.jp/kato.